Team PixelMinds: Project SkillProof

Date: March 28, 2026

1. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Early-career developers and CS students cannot reliably prove genuine project understanding, forcing recruiters into lengthy manual verification or leading to rejection of qualified candidates.

2. PROBLEM DESCRIPTION

1. **Problem Context:** Recruiters need fast, reliable signals of project ownership amidst high candidate volumes. Current screening is often disconnected from real-world project skills.
2. **Problem Faced by the Customer:** Developers lack a standardized, trusted signal to verify project-based skills, leading to rejections despite genuine technical ability.
3. **Typical Customers & Pain Points:** Our typical customers are early-career developers and CS students. They feel this is a problem because they cannot prove project ownership and lack trusted signals for applications. Recruiters and colleges lose genuine builders to low-confidence screening and waste time on manual verification.
4. **Solution Acknowledgment & Willingness to Pay:** Developer demand confirms a high willingness to pay for a tool that offers 'instantly prove project understanding' and provides 'shareable verification badges'. Recruiters and placement cells expressed high interest in faster batch verification and efficient pre-screen insights.
5. **References:** Please refer to the 'Do recruiters trust GitHub portfolios?' survey data.

3. IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE (ICP)

Technologically proficient final-year CS students, early-career engineers, and freelancers seeking product roles but undervalued by traditional screening. They require objective, project-based skill validation to accelerate professional credibility and job acquisition.

4. CUSTOMER PERSONA

Persona 1: Mithun (21, Student)

Core Identity

- Profile: Final Year CSE Student & Freelancer

- Stack: React, Node.js, Python

Aspirations/Goals

- Secure high-value offers and build a credible professional brand.

Pain Points

- Fails speed-based DSA screenings despite significant project depth; unable to prove ownership.

Application Habits

- Prioritizes onboarding speed and often overlooks technical verification of project-based skills.

SkillProof Motivation

- Needs project-grounded scoring and public badges for instant recruiter confidence and objective sanity check

Persona 2: Ramya (22, Student/Freelancer)

Core Identity

- Stack: React, Node.js, Python

Aspirations/Goals

- Aims for competitive offers and establishing professional credibility.

Pain Points

- Rejected in early rounds due to recruiter inability to distinguish genuine work from tutorials.

Application Habits

- Submits portfolios that lack standardized verification signals.

SkillProof Motivation

- Requires objective technical scoring to verify project ownership.